

Acme Corporation

Engineering — Production Incident Response Runbook

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1. Purpose

This runbook defines how the Engineering on-call rotation detects, triages, escalates, and resolves production incidents affecting Acme's customer-facing services. It complements but does not replace the Information Security Incident Reporting process defined in the IT Security Policy (ACME-POL-IT-014) for incidents with a security or data-exposure component.

2. Severity Levels and Response Targets

Production incidents are classified SEV1 through SEV4. Response and mitigation targets below apply to engineering on-call response, which is distinct from the Security Operations Center's security incident response times.

Severity	Definition	Ack Target	Mitigation Target
SEV1	Full outage or data loss risk, all customers affected	5 minutes	30 minutes
SEV2	Major feature unavailable, subset of customers affected	15 minutes	2 hours
SEV3	Degraded performance, workaround available	1 hour	1 business day
SEV4	Minor/cosmetic issue, no customer impact	1 business day	Next sprint

3. On-Call Escalation Path

- Primary on-call engineer is paged automatically via PagerDuty when an alert fires or a SEV1/SEV2 is manually declared in #incidents.
- If unacknowledged within the target window, PagerDuty auto-escalates to the secondary on-call engineer.
- For SEV1 incidents, the Incident Commander role is activated automatically and a dedicated Zoom bridge and #incident- Slack channel are created.
- If the incident involves suspected unauthorized access, data exfiltration, or a security control failure, the on-call engineer must also notify the Security Operations Center (SOC) immediately per the IT Security Policy — this triggers the separate, higher-priority security response track.

4. Roles During an Incident

Role	Responsibility
Incident Commander (IC)	Owns overall coordination and external communication decisions
Primary On-Call	Leads technical investigation and mitigation
Scribe	Maintains the incident timeline in the incident channel
Comms Lead	Drafts status page updates and customer-facing communication

5. Status Page and Customer Communication

SEV1 and SEV2 incidents require a status page update within 15 minutes of declaration, with follow-up updates at least every 30 minutes until resolution. The Comms Lead is responsible for review by a Director-level approver before any update referencing customer data impact is published.

6. Postmortem Requirements

All SEV1 and SEV2 incidents require a blameless postmortem document published within 5 business days of resolution, including a timeline, root cause analysis, and at least one concrete follow-up action with an owner and due date. Postmortems are reviewed in the weekly Engineering Reliability sync and archived in the Incident Postmortems space in Confluence.

7. Relationship to Security Incident Response

This runbook governs operational/availability incidents. Any incident involving a suspected security breach, unauthorized access, malware, or exposure of Confidential or Restricted data must be handled under the Information Security Incident Reporting process in the IT Security Policy (ACME-POL-IT-014, Section 5), which specifies a 15-minute response target for critical security incidents. On-call engineers should treat that target as the operative one whenever a security dimension is identified, even if this runbook's SEV classification would otherwise suggest a longer window.

This document is classified Internal Use Only. For questions, contact the Engineering Reliability team at reliability@acmecorp-internal.example.